



## Leadtek WinFast DTV1800 H

### Two Thumbs Up

The WinFast DTV1800 H is a hybrid PCI TV Tuner capable of receiving analogue as well as terrestrial digital (DVB-T) transmissions, which are currently available only in a few metros. The Conexant CX23880-39 + Zarlink 10353 chipset enables it to decode stereo audio. The audio cable connects internally to the PC-audio solutions, so no more looping cables collecting cobwebs at the back of your PC.

The front-end is provided by the excellent WinFast PVR2 that features Scheduling and TimeShifting, as well as recording in WMV, Transport Stream, as well as MPEG-1/2 (and no additional activation or purchase is required for its

use). It remains perched quietly in the system tray and springs into action when launched using the icon or the full-function remote. The PVR2 even lets you use two TV-Tuners simultaneously, so you can either watch two TV channels, watch one and record the other, or watch TV and use the second TV-Tuner for surveillance.

It detects even the weakest of cable TV and FM radio channels. Video as well as audio quality is top-notch.

#### RATINGS

|                 |       |
|-----------------|-------|
| Performance     | ★★★★★ |
| Features        | ★★★★★ |
| Ease of use     | ★★★★★ |
| Value for Money | ★★★★★ |
| Overall         | ★★★★★ |



You can force the aspect ratio to either 4:3 or 16:9—a delight for wide-screen users.

To sum it up, the WinFast DTV1800 H gives you the best of both worlds, and we give it a double thumbs-up—no complaints.

#### Specifications

Chipset: Conexant 23880-39 + Zarlink 10353; Tuner: Xceive 3018 TV/FM Stereo; TV

reception: Analogue, DVB-T; Video standards: PAL, NTSC, SECAM; Software: WinFast PVR2; Video capture formats: WMV, MPEG-1/2, Transport Stream; Remote control; Input ports: Coaxial, S-Video

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Web site: www.leadtek.com  
Price: Rs 3,900

## LG Black Label Series KE970 “Shine”

### If only looks could matter

Not all manufacturers are innovators of style. Ever since it launched the Chocolate a year ago, LG has been on to something, and that something is its new classy mobile line-up, of which the Black Label Series KE970 (a.k.a. Shine) is what we got to lay our hands on.

Encased in a full-metallic body with a rich brush finish, the KE970 is as rugged as a tank. It is wider than most mobiles. The highlight here is its 2.2-inch LCD, which not only looks good while it is on, but doubles up as a mirror when not lit up!

The keys offer good tactile feedback. LG has introduced the rolling scroll button for the first time, but we found it rather inconvenient: it is very frustrating to keep scrolling through long lists and Web pages. Probably because of the scroller, the UI is vertical



menu-based rather than icon-based—rather unintuitive.

The Shine has an excellent 2.0 MP camera with autofocus. It is certified by Schneider Kreuznach, the German company that

certifies photo-optics. The camera does live up to its hype, and is one of the best we have seen thus far. You can choose from a host of different resolutions and there are five white balance settings, along with a few artistic effects. The camera is a bit sluggish, though.

The media player is decent. Bluetooth 1.2 with A2DP support—wirefree stereo music on a supported headset. There is support to view most common office formats, but the internal memory is just 50 MB, and you'll need to use the microSD slot to add more—irritatingly, it's not hot-swappable. Lost Mobile Track (LMT) function is inbuilt to allow you to trace the phone in case you lose it.

We found the call

quality decent, the KE970 is weaker at signal reception than most phones we have seen. You can't make a call or even send a message when the phone is connected to the PC.

To sum it up, the LG Black Label KE970 is über-high on style, but there are certain issues that need to be addressed. The price tag of Rs 19,000 is a little too much—there are better deals out there.

#### Specifications

GSM 900/GSM 1800/GSM 1900; Display: 2.2-inch with mirror finish; 240 x 320; 256K colours; Camera: 2.0 MP, autofocus, flash; Memory: 50 MB internal, microSD; Connectivity: GPRS, EDGE, Bluetooth 1.2 with A2DP, USB; Weight: 118 g; Dimensions: 99.8 (H) x 50.6 (W) x 13.8 (D) mm; Accessories: Charger, USB cable, stereo handsfree, lanyard

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Web site: www.lgezbuy.com  
Price: Rs 12,990

#### RATINGS

|                 |       |
|-----------------|-------|
| Feature         | ★★★★★ |
| Performance     | ★★★★★ |
| Build Quality   | ★★★★★ |
| Value for Money | ★★★★★ |
| Overall         | ★★★★★ |